

GACA Class 1 Aero-Medical Certificate

The medical standard for commercial flying



Indicative study aid — not an official GACA document. Every age, hour, validity period and requirement must be verified against the current GACAR and confirmed with GACA before you rely on it. These points are condensed from the Fly GACA guide named below.

WHO NEEDS IT

- Mandatory for any pilot exercising commercial privileges.
- CPL, ATPL and flight-instructor work all sit behind it.

THE EXAMINER

- A GACA-approved Aero-Medical Examiner (AME) — book early, slots are limited.
- Bring ID, any glasses and prescriptions, and your full medical history.

WHAT IS TESTED

- Cardiology — resting 12-lead ECG, blood pressure.
- Ophthalmology — acuity, colour vision, intraocular pressure, fundus.
- Audiology — pure-tone audiogram; respiratory and lab work.
- Neurological screening and a structured mental-health interview.

VALIDITY

- 12 months for single-pilot commercial under age 40.
- Shorter intervals apply thereafter.

FIVE MOST-COMMON DEFERRALS

- Refractive error · blood pressure · diabetes.
- Sleep apnoea · a mental-health history.
- All manageable with the right documentation up front.

Condensed from the full Fly GACA guide — <https://flygaca-firebase.web.app/guides/gaca-medical-class-1.html>. Fly GACA is an independent educational reference and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or connected to the General Authority of Civil Aviation (GACA). The authoritative source for any regulation is always GACA — gaca.gov.sa.